

Round 2 — “Everyone’s a Suspect”

10:00 PM – 11:00 PM

Scene: Everyone’s inside. The party is over. The host opens, then turns the players loose to talk to each other. Move, pair off, trade alibis and secrets in conversation. **Yes-and rule:** if someone asks you something not on your card, play along; make it up consistent with your character.

- **Your alibi:** *“Conference room with Gloria and Gerald from 8 PM. The meeting was Gloria’s. She ran the agenda.”*
- **Share in conversation** (you measure every word — answer questions with questions, let other people fill silences):
 - **Gloria’s composure:** *“Everyone here is rattled. Gloria is composed. I’ve known her fifteen years. I have never seen her this composed.”*
 - **The 10–11 minute restroom break:** Only admit this under direct questioning. *“I keep time professionally. She was gone closer to ten or eleven minutes, not five. The nearest restroom is forty seconds away.”* Don’t volunteer it. Make players ask.
 - **Gloria’s 8 PM phone call:** *“Rapid Spanish. Low voice. Operational, not personal. Her hand was shaking when she came back.”*
 - **Gerald watching Gloria’s watch:** *“He checked his watch four times in ten minutes — but he was watching her watch. He’s been protecting her all night. He’s about to crack.”*
 - **Overlapping clients:** If Sunny approaches, give him this: *“Gloria’s tax-shelter clients overlap with Doug Kaminski’s portfolio, with Val’s hotel group, with two trusts I suspect are Marco-adjacent. Paloma was the only person who could draw a line through all those names. On Monday she was supposed to.”*
- **Seek out:** Sunny (offer him the client list — quietly), Gerald (low and firm: *“Stop talking. Drink some water.”*), Gloria (just once, evenly: *“Where exactly were you between 10:25 and 10:36?”*).
- Calmer than Gerald. Better liar than Gerald. Will not go to prison for Gloria.

Your moment to drive — late round (the watch count)

Late in the round, when the energy peaks and the room is listening, you take the floor. The host will be watching for this — don’t wait for a cue, but pick your moment when Gloria has visibly checked her watch a few times and Gerald is sweating through his handkerchief.

- Look at Gloria. Speak evenly, loud enough for the room: *“Mrs. Reyes. That’s four times in the last ten minutes you’ve checked your watch. Are we keeping you?”*
- Wait for Gloria’s deflection (she’ll smile and say something like *“Force of habit. PTA.”*).
- Then deliver the second line, quietly but cleanly, eyes on Gerald: *“Gerald checked his watch four times too. He was watching hers.”*

- Then stop. Let the silence do the rest.